

But then, there is a huge gain in terms of weight as netbooks are almost half the weight of notebooks. While a 35.6-38cm notebook weighs 2.2-2.6 kg, a 25.9cm (10.2-inch) netbook weighs 1-1.2 kg. Also, netbooks generally have a longer battery life than notebooks because netbooks consume less power owing to the lighter tasks that they are used for.

From smartphones and iPad. A smartphone is not a PC. It is basically a phone with e-mail and Internet access capabilities. On the other hand, a netbook is designed for not just Internet access and e-mail but office work also—like presentations, which aren't possible with smartphones. A smartphone won't cover the functions that a businessman may require on the go. With the QWERTY keypad of a smartphone, you can't type a document comfortably as it has small keys. On the other hand, a netbook has a keyboard almost the size of a notebook's.

If you compare with iPads, netbook and iPad are two different devices. iPad is more like an e-book and it doesn't function like a PC.

Buying tips

If you've made up your mind to go for a netbook, try to get the best configuration within your budget. Take a look at the things that you must consider in a netbook.

Processor. Most netbooks ship with Intel's Atom processors that run at 1.6 GHz. The 1.66GHz N450, a just recently launched mainstream CPU for netbooks, is recommended. It is an SoC with an integrated graphics and DDR2 memory controller, and is one of the most power-efficient netbook CPUs available today. Ninety-five per cent of all the netbooks sold use this CPU. Rest five per cent come with N270—an older version. Some netbooks, though, come with the VIA and ARM-enabled chipsets as well.

A new Intel Atom processor is likely to be available by September this year.

RAM. The recommended RAM

Acer Aspire One 532h

Features

- Screen size: 25.7 cm (10.1 inches)
- Display resolution: 1024x600 (WSVGA), high-brightness (200-nit) Acer CrystalBrite LED-backlit TFT LCD
- Netbook keyboard size: 84-/85-/88-key keyboard, 93 per cent of standard-size keyboard
- Operating system (Windows or Linux): Genuine Windows 7 Starter
- Hard drive size, type (solidstate or spinning): 6.4cm (2.5-inch) 9.5mm 160/250 GB
- Processor: Intel Atom N450
- Gaming/graphics chipset: Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 3150
- Installed memory (RAM): DDR2 667MHz SDRAM memory interface design, with one soDIMM slot that supports 1GB soDIMMs for total system memory of up to 1 GB
- Battery type and life: 63W 5600mAh 6-cell Li-ion battery pack with 10-hour battery life, 48W 4400mAh 6-cell Li-ion battery pack with 8-hour battery life or 24W 2200mAh 3-cell Li-ion battery pack with 4-hour battery life
- Wireless connectivity: Acer InviLink Nplify 802.11b/g/n Wi-Fi certified, Acer InviLink 802.11b/g Wi-Fi certified, supporting Acer SignalUp wireless technology, Bluetooth 2.1+EDR
- USB ports: Three USB 2.0 ports
- Weight: 1.1 kg for models with 3-cell battery pack, 1.25 kg for models with 6-cell battery pack



**Price
Rs 18,461**

ASUS Eee PC 1005P

Features

- Screen size: 25.7 cm (10.1 inches)
- Display resolution: 1024x600 pixels
- Netbook keyboard size: 92 per cent the size of generic notebooks
- Operating system (Windows or Linux): Windows 7 Starter
- Hard drive size, type (solidstate or spinning): 250 GB spinning
- Processor: Intel Atom N450
- Gaming/graphics chipset: None
- Installed Memory (RAM): 1 GB
- Battery type and life: 6-cell, 11 hours
- Wireless connectivity: 802.11 b/g/n + BT
- USB ports: 3
- Weight: 1.27 kg



**Price
Rs 19,790
(excluding taxes)**